

education software, and huge blackboards will give them away.)

9. Homeschool support group

If you are homeschooling and haven't joined a local support group, you are missing out! In addition to access to cheap and fun activities, discounts, conferences, and educational programs, there is often a forum or email list for trading and selling used curriculum. The best deals come from those you know!

One of the biggest expenses you will bear as a home-educating parent is the curriculum. Get out there and get informed about what you will need and what it will cost so that you are prepared to barter your way to a cheaper school year. If you make a mistake, just resell it. It's all about learning, anyway. — **Linsey Knerl**

8 Endurance Principles for Staying the Frugal Course

Frugality is a lifestyle choice that allows you to live within your means, resist impulsive consumer habits, and enjoy the things you have debt-free. But don't be fooled: As frugal days turn into frugal years and frugal decades, bag lunches can become boring; smallish houses, confining; thrift-shop clothing, unfashionable. And though you may not care what people think of your "voluntary simplicity," it can become tiresome to always live outside of an acquisition-oriented, size-counts-the-most social norm. When frugality starts feeling like a sacrifice, you're in danger of falling off the wagon. Here are eight endurance tips for staying the frugal course.

1. Don't let frugality inhibit your ambition.

Just because you can live on less doesn't mean that you have to make